Cisplatin + fluorouracil every 4 weeks

Cisplatin and fluorouracil are used to treat head and neck cancer. The treatment aim depends on the extent of the cancer and your wider plan; ask your team to record whether the aim is disease control, symptom relief or part of another treatment strategy.

Treatment of locally advanced or metastatic head and neck cancer. · NCCP 00314 v4b · Document revised 10 November 2026

Your personal plan: this is the standard regimen schedule. Your team confirms your prescribed doses, cycles, treatment changes and appointments in your written plan.

Treatment of locally advanced or metastatic head and neck cancer.

My overall treatment

Every 28 days; duration reviewed with your team.

28 day view

Treatment timing in this window

Cisplatin and hydration — Day 1–4

Fluorouracil infusions — Day 1–4 · One 22-hour infusion on each of Days 1–4.

Four daily treatment days
Days 1–4: cisplatin each day, plus fluorouracil over 22 hours each day.

Recovery and next review
The next cycle is planned every 28 days, subject to safety and benefit review; no fixed course length.

A typical 28-day cycle

Day 1–4	Day 5–28
Treatment and infusion days	Recovery and review

Timing may change after review. Side effects can occur on any day; there are no guaranteed safe days.

My tests and checks

When	What is checked	Timing / reason
Before	**Safety and preparation** NCCP / individual plan	Blood count, kidney/liver tests and dihydropyrimidine dehydrogenase (a medicine-processing enzyme) (DPD) assessment; electrocardiogram (ECG), hearing and additional kidney tests when indicated.
During	**Blood tests and symptoms** NCCP	Blood count and kidney/liver tests before each cycle; review hydration, hearing, nerves and symptoms.
After / response	**Follow-up and assessment** NCCP / individual plan	Follow ongoing side effects. Scans, examinations and further tests follow your individual plan.

Between treatments

- Four 22-hour fluorouracil infusions on Days 1–4; daily changes and final disconnection follow the actual connection times.
- Report fever or sudden illness promptly. Follow the written support plan; do not wait for the next visit if symptoms worsen.

Bring your medicines list, appointment calendar, test results and verified urgent contacts.

When to get help
Call 112 / 999 for severe breathing difficulty, severe chest pain, collapse or a seizure.
Call oncology immediately: temperature 37.5°C or above, 36°C or below, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your hospital's temperature instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment. Do not wait for the next appointment.

Oncology daytime: 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321
EXAMPLE ONLY — team must replace both numbers before patient use.

Feasibility build. Clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Your team confirms your personal plan.

What to watch for

You do not need to know which medicine caused a symptom before calling.

1 Hearing / balance

Cisplatin

Report tinnitus, hearing loss or balance change before another dose; some changes may persist.

2 Mouth / swallowing

Fluorouracil

Report ulcers, painful swallowing or difficulty drinking; early severe symptoms need urgent review.

3 Heart / chest

Fluorouracil

Chest pain, tightness, palpitations or collapse needs urgent assessment during or after an infusion.

4 Kidneys / fluids

Cisplatin

Report much less urine, vomiting or poor drinking. Prescribed fluids and blood tests protect kidney function.

5 Bowels / hydration

Fluorouracil

Call early for diarrhoea, severe tummy pain, dizziness or inability to keep fluids down.

6 Hands / feet

Fluorouracil

Report sore, red or peeling palms or soles before they limit walking or ordinary activities.

7 Hands / feet / nerves

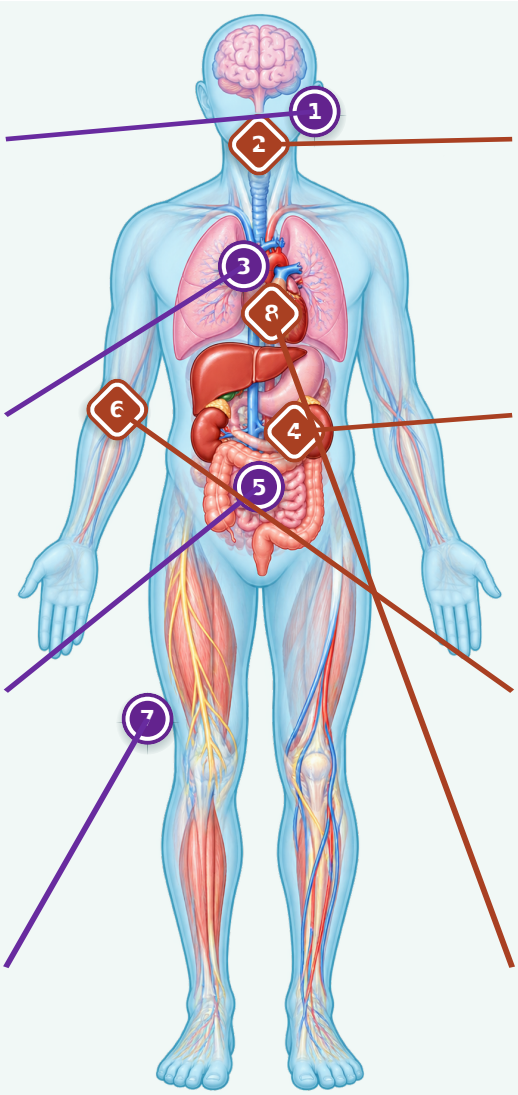
Cisplatin

Report tingling, numbness, weakness or difficulty using your hands or walking.

8 Blood cells / infection

Chemotherapy

Fever, shivering, sudden illness, unusual bruising or bleeding needs prompt oncology advice.



Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Call oncology immediately for fever, shivering, sudden illness, persistent vomiting, diarrhoea, severe mouth pain or inability to drink. Chest pain during or after fluorouracil, or unusually early severe symptoms, needs urgent assessment even if DPD testing was normal. Severe chest pain, severe breathing difficulty, collapse or a seizure is an emergency.

When to get help

Call 112 / 999 for severe breathing difficulty, severe chest pain, collapse or a seizure.

Call oncology immediately: temperature 37.5°C or above, 36°C or below, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your hospital's temperature instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment. Do not wait for the next appointment.

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Keep your treatment details to hand

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Print this page **one-sided on A4 at Actual size / 100%**. Cut only the dashed outer border around both panels. **Do not cut the centre line.** Fold with FRONT and BACK facing out, then glue or tape the blank backs together. Finished size: **85.6 × 54 mm**. Keep the stamp side writable.

FRONT / CONTACTS

My Treatment Card

SACTCheck

Name: _____

Cisplatin + fluorouracil

Every 28 days; duration reviewed with your team.

Phase: _____ Cycle plan: team to confirm

Daytime (EXAMPLE) 087 12345678

Out of hours (EXAMPLE) 087 87654321

Unwell or fever? Call oncology now.
Severe breathing difficulty, chest pain or collapse: **112 / 999.**

EXAMPLE NUMBERS — replace before patient use.

BACK / TREATMENT RECORD

My cycle record

Rolling cycle record; your team confirms the intended number and reviews benefit and safety.

Cycle	Date / initials

My treatment information

Latest treatment date: _____

Plan changed? Ask the team to update this card.

CUT outer border

FOLD centre — do not cut

Keep the record accurate

The team dates and initials each recorded treatment unit when complete. A cycle is complete after its final planned dose; a weekly-treatment stamp records that weekly dose. Delays, omitted doses or a changed plan need a note or a replacement card. A stamp does not approve the next treatment. Keep any medicine-specific alert card too.

Put your treatment page on your phone

Scan your QR and check the treatment name. Save that page to your home screen.

iPhone / Safari

Tap Share → Add to Home Screen. Select Open as Web App if offered, then Add.

Android / Chrome

Tap the three-dot menu → Add to Home screen or Install and create shortcut. Choose the shortcut option and confirm.

Menu wording varies. The QR opens information, not a personal record. Paper stamps do not update the website. Check that the saved icon opens the correct treatment.

Your local contacts and resources

Oncology daytime: 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321

EXAMPLE ONLY — team must replace both numbers before patient use.

Hospital / team: _____

Backup if the team cannot be reached: _____

Additional local services and resources will be added when confirmed. Your team must check and complete this page before patient use.

Feasibility build. Clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Your team confirms your personal plan.